AUSTRIA · VIENNA

Vienna

4 Day Imperial City Journey

DESTINATION	DURATION	IDEAL FOR
Austria, Vienna	4 days	2–4 people

YOUR JOURNEY

Expedition Route

Austria · Vienna · 4 days

DAY 1
Vienna · St Stephen's · Hofburg · Ringstrasse

DAY 2
Vienna · Schönbrunn Palace · Vienna Woods

DAY 3
Vienna · Belvedere · Secession

DAY 4
Naschmarkt · Prater · Vienna State Opera

JOURNEY HIGHLIGHTS

- St Stephen's Cathedral — the Gothic spire that has defined the Viennese skyline since 1160
- Schönbrunn Palace and its formal gardens
- Vienna State Opera — a performance in the house Mahler ran
- Hofburg Palace and the Spanish Riding School
- The Belvedere and Gustav Klimt's The Kiss
- The Prater Ferris Wheel at dusk, looking over the city

DAY 1

The First District — St Stephen's, Hofburg & the Ringstrasse

Begin at St Stephen's Cathedral in the morning — climb the south tower for the view over the old city. Walk through the first district to the Hofburg: the Habsburg imperial complex that grew for six centuries and never quite finished. The Spanish Riding School if there is a morning exercise session. Afternoon on the Ringstrasse boulevard: the Opera, the Parliament, the Kunsthistorisches Museum.

- St Stephen's Cathedral — Vienna's Gothic masterpiece and the city's spiritual centre
- Hofburg Palace — 2,600 rooms, 19 courtyards, the heart of a 600-year empire
- Spanish Riding School — the 16th-century equestrian institution still in its original hall
- Ringstrasse — the boulevard of monumental buildings Franz Joseph I commissioned in 1857

INSIDER TIP

The Spanish Riding School morning exercise sessions (Morgenarbeit) are cheaper and more intimate than the formal performances — book well in advance. St Stephen's south tower climb is 343 steps with no lift; the north tower has a lift to the Pummerin bell. The Ringstrasse is most photogenic in late afternoon light.

DAY 2

Schönbrunn Palace & the Vienna Woods

The day outside the city centre. Schönbrunn in the morning before the coach tours: the Baroque palace's 1,441 rooms, the formal French gardens, the Gloriette hilltop pavilion with its view back over Vienna. Afternoon in the Vienna Woods — the forested hills above the city that Beethoven walked and Schubert set to music. Return for an evening coffee in a first-district café.

- Schönbrunn Palace — the Habsburg summer residence, a UNESCO World Heritage Site
- Schönbrunn Gardens — the French formal gardens with the Neptune Fountain and Gloriette
- Gloriette — the hilltop colonnade with the finest panoramic view of Vienna
- Vienna Zentralfriedhof — the cemetery where Beethoven, Brahms and Schubert are buried

INSIDER TIP

Schönbrunn opens at 8am — the first hour is dramatically quieter than mid-morning. The Gloriette hilltop is a 15-minute walk through the formal gardens and has the best panoramic view of Vienna. The Zentralfriedhof (Central Cemetery), where Beethoven, Brahms and Schubert are buried, is a 20-minute tram ride from the centre.

DAY 3

The Belvedere, Klimt & Vienna Secession

The art morning. Upper Belvedere for Klimt: The Kiss is here, along with Schiele's self-portraits and a Monet view of the palace gardens. Walk to the Vienna Secession — the 1897 building whose gold-leaf dome is one of the city's architectural jokes, and in the basement Klimt's Beethoven Frieze. Afternoon at the Kunsthistorisches Museum: the Bruegel collection is among the finest in the world.

- Upper Belvedere — the Baroque summer palace housing Klimt's The Kiss
- Vienna Secession — the 1897 exhibition hall of Klimt, Schiele and their circle
- Klimt's Beethoven Frieze — the 34-metre painting cycle in the Secession basement
- Kunsthistorisches Museum — one of the great encyclopaedic art collections of Europe

INSIDER TIP

The Beethoven Frieze in the Vienna Secession basement should be studied slowly — read the programme notes before entering the small room. The Upper Belvedere sells timed entry tickets; the first slot at 9am is the most rewarding. The Kunsthistorisches Museum's Bruegel room holds more Bruegels than anywhere else in the world.

DAY 4

Naschmarkt, Prater & the Vienna State Opera

Final morning at the Naschmarkt — Vienna's outdoor market running along the Wienzeile: produce, cheese, wine and the Saturday flea market. Walk to the Prater for the afternoon: the public park that has been open to everyone since 1766, and the Wiener Riesenrad — the 1897 giant Ferris wheel with its wooden gondolas and panoramic views. Evening at the Vienna State Opera if there is a performance.

- Naschmarkt — Vienna's 1.5-kilometre open-air market, open since the 16th century
- Prater — the imperial pleasure ground turned public park, 3,000 acres of paths and meadows
- Wiener Riesenrad — the 1897 Ferris Wheel, one of the oldest surviving in the world
- Vienna State Opera — the neo-Renaissance opera house completed in 1869

INSIDER TIP

The Naschmarkt Saturday flea market extends the full length of the regular market — arrive by 8am before the best pieces disappear. The Wiener Riesenrad operates year-round; the original 1897 wooden gondolas are heated in winter. A cycle along the Prater's Hauptallee takes 20 minutes and gives a completely different sense of the park's scale.

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This guide gives you the structure and route.
Our planners can build the personalised version around your dates, travel style and pace.

- Refined route planning and pacing
- Carefully selected areas to stay
- Logistics guidance for a smooth journey
- Insider tips from on-the-ground research

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